the global South, and has hopes for Chinese investment. Indian political leaders also urgently need to balance China and to do what they can to fend off closer relations between either China or Russia and India's archrival, Pakistan. Neither India nor Brazil wishes to offend the West, including Japan, and both resist defining the BRICS as "anti-Western," a rhetorical stance that sometimes appeals to Russia and China. For their part, South African leaders remain conscious of their country's less materially capable position, both globally and within the BRICS, and have prudently chosen to go along with the club on most specific global issues, hoping for national and African regional advantages, especially in the form of investment from China and the other larger BRICS countries.

Finally, what are the implications of the rise of the BRICS' collective financial statecraft? On balance, the BRICS have been relatively constructive players in global economic and financial governance—dissatisfied with their degree of influence, and not as accepting of unwanted policy rules as U.S. security allies such as Japan and South Korea—but in agreement on many basic principles underpinning the global economic system. Despite their domestic varieties of capitalism, they have been only moderately revisionist—certainly not *spoilers* in this area—owing at least in part to the pull of domestic reformers[62] or, in the case of the democracies, shared values with Western liberal states. Overall, this record testifies to the soundness of the U.S. strategy to draw in systemically significant states into the U.S.-led liberal economic order and its continuing logic. From within this domain of the global order, the BRICS have often opted for financial statecraft aiming to accomplish inside reform. Peaceful change could continue to be possible if the major players, both incumbent and rising powers, are willing to adjust incrementally, given the overriding benefits of the existing order.

Such adjustment by the United States and the West will not come easily, however, as suggested by Lawrence Summer's epigraph at the beginning of this chapter. Despite the recent waning of Europe and the G7 Concert, the United States remains the dominant power and has demonstrated its willingness and ability to leverage its financial capabilities to compensate for its declining share of the world economy. The BRICS perceive Washington's use of financial statecraft, in the form of sanctions and controlling access to the nodes of the international financial system, as coercive, and these actions have provoked the group's collective defensive responses, as evidenced in the cases discussed in this volume. If the backlash by the BRICS and other countries contributes to an eroding of U.S. leverage as they invoke their